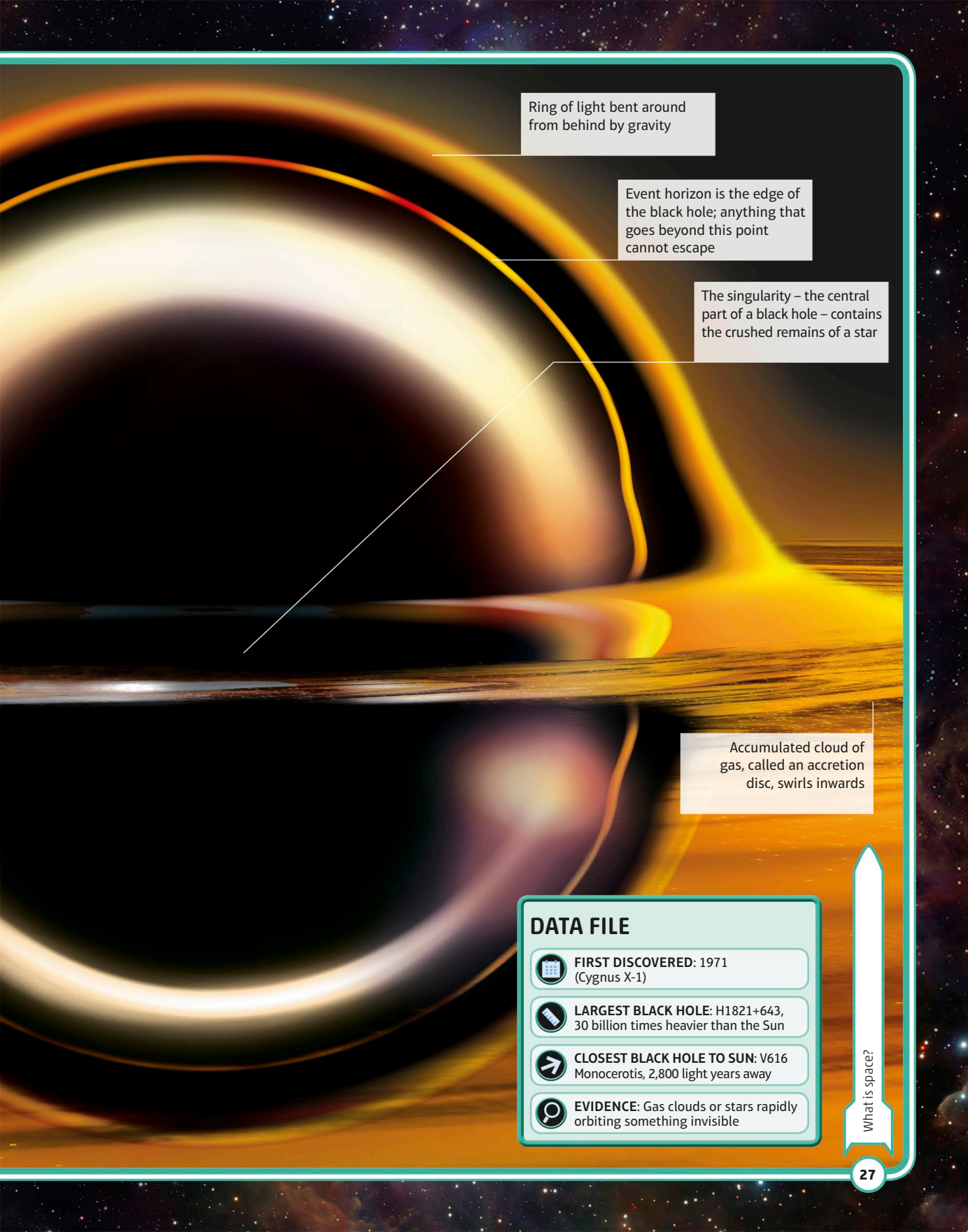




Ring of light bent around
from behind by gravity

Event horizon is the edge of
the black hole; anything that
goes beyond this point
cannot escape

The singularity – the central
part of a black hole – contains
the crushed remains of a star

Accumulated cloud of
gas, called an accretion
disc, swirls inwards

DATA FILE



FIRST DISCOVERED: 1971
(Cygnus X-1)



LARGEST BLACK HOLE: H1821+643,
30 billion times heavier than the Sun



CLOSEST BLACK HOLE TO SUN: V616
Monocerotis, 2,800 light years away



EVIDENCE: Gas clouds or stars rapidly
orbiting something invisible

What is space?